

June 23, 2026

Subject: Letter of Commitment – Salish Sea Dreaming BC Arts Council Application

Dear BC Arts Council Assessment Committee,

Please accept this letter as formal confirmation of my commitment to the **Salish Sea Dreaming** project for the upcoming BC Arts Council Media Artists grant application.

Having helped build and run the technical foundation of this project through its two public installations to date, I am committed to continuing our collaboration into its next phase. My role will be to provide technical leadership across the interactive visitor experience, the real-time generative visual pipeline, and the production systems that keep the installation running reliably in the field — work for which I have agreed to a total compensation of **\$3,250**, billed at my standard hourly rate.

I bring a background in software and interactive-systems engineering. For Salish Sea Dreaming's two 2026 public showings — on **Salt Spring Island (April 2026)** and at the **H.R. MacMillan Space Centre (IMPACT, May 2026)** — I built and operated the live technical stack: the visitor co-dreaming application that lets audience members shape the dream from their own phones, the live “dream cloud” archive that gathers and displays those contributions, the real-time AI generative visual pipeline, and the resilient, self-healing field operations that allow the work to run reliably and largely unattended. I also bring data-science and data-engineering capability to support the project's data-driven elements as it grows.

For the upcoming phase, my focus will be on hardening this infrastructure for touring and for a larger-format dome experience — making the system portable, robust, and dependable enough to bring to new venues and audiences while preserving the depth and responsiveness of the visitor interaction.

I am fully committed to the timeline and goals of Salish Sea Dreaming and look forward to helping bring this meaningful work to new audiences through advanced media technology.

Sincerely,

Darren Zal Technical Lead — Interactive Systems & Infrastructure, Salish Sea Dreaming zaldarren@gmail.com